

We Were Nineteen

a piano-pop ballad for solo piano, with lyrics — a college love story (ideas annotated in the score)

original composition

Steady pulse (♩ = 72)

Chords: C#m⁹ A^Δ#11 E^Δ9/G# F#m¹¹ C#m⁹
hook motif E-D#-E-B (syncopated), reharmonized every bar
steady piano pulse A^Δ9#11: Lydian E^Δ9/G#: inversion F#m11: Dorian 13th (D#)

Lyrics:
Freshman fall, a borrowed pen,
Reading lights till half past ten,
You were quoting someone wise,
I was studying your eyes.
We were nineteen,
on the back of the moon,
We were nine-teen,
everything felt new,
We were nine-teen,
cap and gown so far a - way,
We were nine-teen,
stay, don't go.
Coffee cups and cheap gui - tars,

Chords: A^Δ#11 F#m¹¹ B¹³ sus4 E^Δ9/G# A^Δ9 A#⁰
the motif echoes each line

Chords: C#m⁹/B D^Δ7#11 G#⁷ b9 C#m⁹ G#⁷ #5 9 E^Δ9 B/D# C#m⁹
A#⁰: half-diminished passing D^Δ7#11: Neapolitan bII, Lydian G#⁹#5: whole-tone hook x4, four harmonizations the hook B/D#: inversion

Chords: C#m⁹ A^Δ9 A#⁰7 A^Δ#11 G#m¹¹ C#⁷ #9
A#⁰7: diminished passing C#⁷#9: blue #9

Chords: F#m¹¹ B¹³ sus4 B¹³ C#m⁹ A^Δ#11

23

F#m¹¹ B¹³ sus4 E^Δ9/G# A^Δ9 A#⁰ C#m⁹/B

Rooftop talks beneath the stars, Finals, fears, and latenight trains,

27

D^Δ7#11 G#7 b9 C#m⁹ G#7 #5 9 E^Δ9 B/D# C#m⁹

Every lesson, you re - mained. *f* We were nine-teen, on the back of the moon,

31

C#m⁹ A^Δ9 A#⁰7 A^Δ#11 G#m¹¹ C#7 #9

We were nine-teen, everything felt new, We were nine-teen, cap and gown so far a - way,

35

F#m¹¹ B¹³ sus4 B¹³ E^Δ9 *relative major (E) years later — E major* D/E *D/E: polychord (E Mixolydian sus)*

We were nineteen, stay, don't go. *mp* Years went by, new names on the doors,

39

C#m⁹ C#m⁹/B A^Δ#11 G#7 #9 C^Δ#11 *C^Δ9#11: chromatic mediant bVI* F#m¹¹ F⁰7 E/G# A¹³ *A13: Lydian dominant #11*

Still I walk those corridors, Something we began at nineteen never learned

44

A7 b9 *A7#9 → up a half step* F^Δ9 *D minor: same hook, new key up a half step — D minor* C/E Dm⁹

to end. *ff* We were nine-teen, on the back of the moon, We were nine-teen,

48 $B\flat^{\Delta 9}$ $B^{\circ 7}$ $B\flat^{\Delta \#11}$ $A\flat^{11}$ $D^7 \#9$ $G\flat^{11}$

everything felt new, We were nine-teen, cap and gown so far a - way, We were nine-teen,

52 $C^{13} \text{ sus4}$ C^{13} $D\flat^{9}$ $B\flat^{\Delta \#11}$ $G\flat^{11}$ $A^7 \flat 9$ $D^{\Delta 9}$

stay, don't go. *p* Picardy third: $D^{\Delta 9}$

Detailed description: This is a musical score for piano, spanning measures 48 to 52. The key signature has two flats (B-flat major). The notation is in standard staff notation with a treble and bass clef. Measures 48-51 are grouped by a brace. Measure 52 is a Picardy third. Chord symbols are written above the staff. Lyrics are written below the staff. A piano (p) dynamic marking is present in measure 52.